Soyoung Lee

Ann Arbor, MI | https://leesoy7351.github.io | soyolee@umich.edu

Education

University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
Ph.D. Information (2022 – *Present*) / Advisor: Nicole Ellison
University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI
M.S. Information (2022) / Advisor: Kentaro Toyama
Chung-Ang University, Seoul, Korea
B.A. English Language and Literature, *Magna Cum Laude* (2014)

Research Experience

Project: Understanding Human-AI Relationships (Dec 2024 – Present)
PI: Soyoung Lee (Advisor: Nicole Ellison)
- Designed and implementing an exploratory interview study on a deeply connected relationship with AI social chatbots around the concept of mutuality building and relationship boundaries

Research Assistant (2021 – July 2024)
Project: The "Community Tech Workers" – A community-driven model to support economic mobility by bridging the digital divide
PIs: Tawanna Dillahunt, Julie Hui, Mustafa Naseem, Kentaro Toyama
- Designed, implemented and analyzed data about basic digital skills learning using survey, semi-structured interview, participant observation
- Assisted development of a measure of community digital capacity
- Facilitated digital skills training with a partnership with a non-profit organization following community-based participatory design approach

Publication

Hui, J., Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.,** Corvite, S., Dillahunt, T.R., `I Know I Can Do the Job, It's Just Putting It Down': Using Personas as a Mirror to Identify Strengths. *2026 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (Accepted)*

Lee, S., Hui, J., Dillahunt, T. R. (2025) Sociocultural Factors in Digital Skills Learning In a Community-Based Learning Intervention among U.S. Public Housing Adults. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, 9(2), CSCW172, 1-26. (CSCW2025 conference presenter)*

Dillahunt, R. T., Shedden, K., Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.**, Naseem M., Toyama, K., Hui, J. (2025). The Development of a New Measure of Collective Digital Literacy: Community Digital Capacity. Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, 9(2), 1-33. *(CSCW 2025 Conference Presenter)*

Lee, S., & Toyama, K (2024). Friendship Formation in an Enforced Online Regime: Findings from a U.S. University Under COVID. *Proceedings of the ACM on Human-Computer Interaction, Vol.8, No. CSCW1, Article 168. (CSCW 2024 Conference Presenter)*

Dillahunt, T. R., K Shedden, Filipof, E. M., **Lee, S.**, Naseem M., Toyama, K., Hui, J. (2024). Toward a Measure of Collective Digital Capacity: An Exploratory Analysis. *Extended Abstracts of the 2024 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems . (CHI 2024 Poster Presenter)*

Lee, S., Hui, J., Rowe, Z., Dillahunt, T. (2023). "A Collective Approach to Providing Digital Skills Training Among U.S. Public Housing Residents" *Extended Abstracts of the 2023 CHI Conference on Human Factors in Computing Systems (CHI 2023 Poster Presenter)*

Under Review
Comm Horizons @ UCD 2026: Communication in the Age of AI and Algorithms *(Abstract submission)*

Teaching Experience

Graduate Student Instructor
- SI 303 Introduction to Qualitative Research (Fall 24, 25, 26 Undergraduate)
- SI 622 Needs Assessment and Usability Evaluation (Winter 25, 26)

Grant/Scholarship

- Precandidate Rackham Graduate Student Research Grant *$1,500* (2025)
- Rackham Conference Travel Grant & School of Information Doctoral Student Travel Grant (2023, 2024, 2025)
- Ascend Education as Equalizer Scholarship *$5,000* (2022)

Service

Paper Review
- ACM CSCW(2024, 2025, 2026)
- ACM CHI (2026)
- AAAI Conference on Artificial Intelligence (AAAI-26) (2026)

Community service
- UMSI Master's Thesis Option Program experience panelist (2024)
- UMSI Graduate Student Instructor orientation panelist (2025)

Mentoring

- Maurice Tobiano (BA in History and Film, Television & Media; Minor in Social Media Design & Analysis)
- Mila Filipof (BS, MS in Information Science)
- Pioline Choudhury (BSE in Computer Science)

Industry Experience

The Cigna Group, Seoul, Korea

Assistant Product Manager, *Digital Platform Team* (2017 – 2020)

- Led new digital product and UX strategy development
- Conducted qualitative (user shadowing, interviews) and quantitative (A/B testing, web log, heatmap) digital product data analysis

Communication Specialist, *IT Project Management Office* (2014 – 2017)

- Designed and conducted change readiness assessment surveys for 800+ employees and 20+ focus group interviews with business/IT teams for new IT operation system
- Developed and coordinated new IT system-training for 7,000+ users; authored system manual documents as user guides